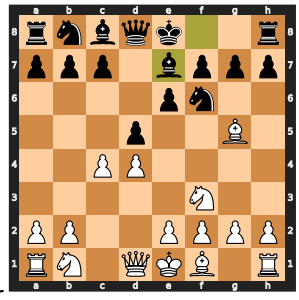
Game 9

Queen's Gambit Declined



Capablanca – Teichmann

Berlin, 1913

White: J. R. Capablanca Black: R. Teichmann

Notes by J. R. Capablanca, from Chess Fundamentals *(1921), which is in the public domain.*
Descriptive notation has been converted to algebraic. Page references are to the book.
Click any move or diagram to open it on Lichess.

1.d4 d5 2.♘f3 ♘f6 3.c4 e6 4.♗g5 ♗e7 5.♘c3 ♘bd7 6.e3 0–0 7.♖c1 b6 8.cxd5 exd5 9.♗b5

An invention of my own, I believe. I played it on the spur of the moment simply to change the normal course of the game. Generally the Bishop goes to d3, or to a6, after 9.♕a4. The text move is in the nature of an ordinary developing move, and as it violates no principle it cannot be bad.

9...♗b7 10.0–0 a6 11.♗a4 ♖c8 12.♕e2 c5 13.dxc5 ♘xc5

If 13...bxc5 14.♖fd1, and White would play to win one of Black's centre Pawns. The drawback to the text move is that it leaves Black's d-pawn isolated, and consequently weak and subject to attack.

14.♖fd1 ♘xa4

The alternative would have been 14...b5 15.♗c2 b4 16.♘a4 ♘ce4.

15.♘xa4 b5 16.♖xc8 ♕xc8 17.♘c3 ♕c4

Black aims at the exchange of Queens in order to remain with two Bishops for the ending, but in this position such a course is a mistake, because the Bishop at b7 is inactive and cannot come into the game by any means, unless Black gives up the isolated Queen's Pawn which the Bishop must defend.

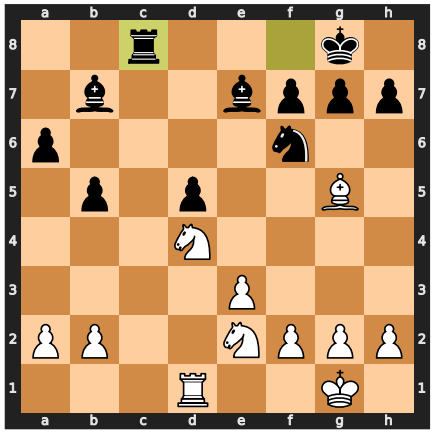
18.♘d4

Not, of course, 18.♖d4, because of 18...♕xe2 19.♘xe2 ♖c8; and there would be no good way to prevent ♖c2.

18...♕xe2 19.♘cxe2!

Notice the co-ordination of the Knights' moves. They are manoeuvred chain-like, so to speak, in order to maintain one of them, either at d4 or ready to go there. Now White threatens to take the open file, and therefore forces Black's next move.

19...♖c8



The student should examine this position carefully. There seems to be no particular danger, yet, as White will demonstrate, Black may be said to be lost. If the game is not altogether lost, the defence is at least of the most difficult kind; indeed, I must confess that I can see no adequate defence against White's next move.

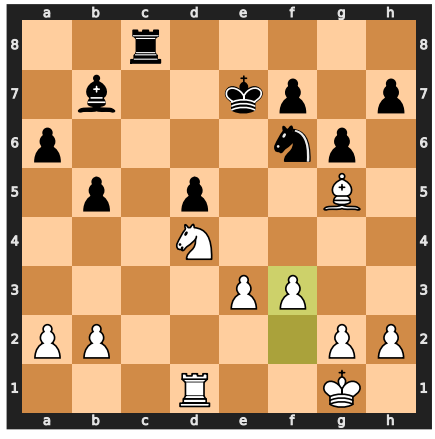
20.♘f5! ♔f8

If 20...♗d8 21.♘d6 ♖c7 22.♘xb7 ♖xb7 23.♗xf6 ♗xf6 24.♖xd5 ♖c7 25.♖d2, and White is a Pawn ahead. If the Bishop moves anywhere else, then ♗xf6, doubling the f-pawn and isolating all of Black's King's side Pawns.

21.♘xe7 ♔xe7 22.♘d4 g6

This is practically forced, as White threatened ♘f5+. Notice that the Black Knight is pinned in such a way that no relief can be afforded except by giving up the h-pawn or abandoning the open file with the Rook, which would be disastrous, as White would immediately sieze it.

23.f3!



23...h6

Black could do nothing else except mark time with his Rook along the open file, since as soon as he moved away White would take it. White, on the other hand, threatens to march up with his King to e5 via f2, g3, f4, after having, of course, prepared the way. Hence, Black's best chance was to give up a Pawn, as in the text, in order to free his Knight.

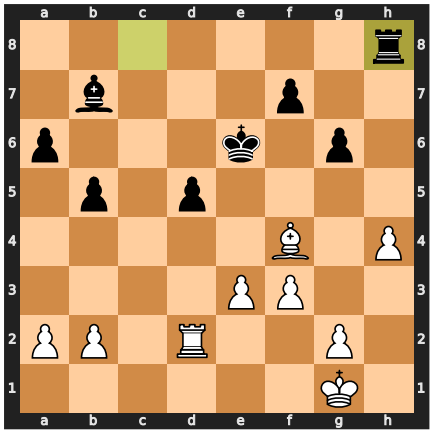
24.♗xh6 ♘d7 25.h4 ♘c5 26.♗f4 ♘e6

Black exchanges Knights to remain with Bishops of opposite colours, which gives him the best chance to draw.

27.♘xe6 ♔xe6

27...fxe6 would be worse, as White would then be able to post his Bishop at e5.

28.♖d2 ♖h8

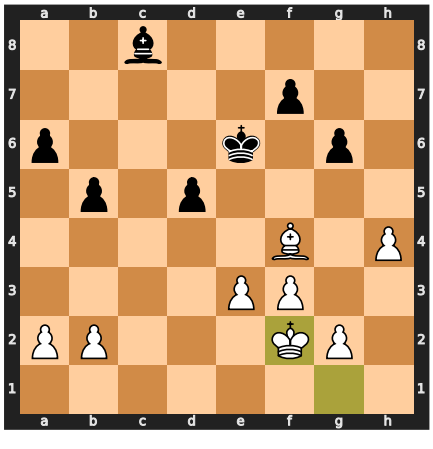


Black wants to force ♗g3. g3 would be bad, on account of ...d4; which would get the Black Bishop into the game, even though White could answer e4. The text move is, however, weak, as will soon be seen. His best chance was to play ...b4; and follow it up with ...a5 and ♗a6. White meanwhile could play g4 and h5, obtaining a passed Pawn, which, with proper play, should win.

29.♖c2! ♖c8 30.♖xc8 ♗xc8

There are now Bishops of opposite colour, but nevertheless White has an easily-won game.

31.♔f2



31...d4

Practically forced. Otherwise the White King would march up to d4 and then to c5 and win Black's Queen's side Pawns. If Black attempted to stop this by putting his King at c6 then the White King would enter through e5 into Black's King's side and win just as easily.

32.exd4 ♔d5 33.♔e3 ♗e6 34.♔d3 ♔c6 35.a3 ♗c4+ 36.♔e3 ♗e6 37.♗h6

It is better not to hurry 37.g4 because of ...f5; for although White could win in any case, it would take longer. Now the White King threatens to help by going in through f4 after posting the Bishop at g7, where it not only protects the d-pawn, but indirectly also the b-pawn.

37...♔d5 38.♗g7
Resigns.

The student ought to have realised by this time the enormous importance of playing well every kind of ending. In this game again, practically from the opening, White aimed at nothing but the isolation of Black's d-pawn. Once he obtained that, he tried for and obtained, fortunately, another advantage of position elsewhere which translated itself into the material advantage of a Pawn. Then by accurate playing in the ending he gradually forced home his advantage. This ending has the merit of having been played against one of the finest players in the world.